



3 Mix up a free-draining gritty compost from John Innes No. 2 and horticultural grit in 3:1 proportions. Remove plants from their pots and gently break up the root ball, teasing out the roots and removing soil. Take care not to damage the roots.



4 Place plants on a layer of compost and then fill in around the root ball, working in the compost with a dibber to reduce air pockets. Tap the container on the work surface to distribute the compost evenly. Top with a layer of decorative gravel. Place on a saucer or similar if you need to protect the table surface.



5 Repot plants into large containers when roots start to show through the tin's drainage hole. Repotting is best done in spring, and watering plants a couple of days before keeps roots moist.

CARE ADVICE



WHERE TO SITE

Cacti and succulents need a sunny site and warmth to thrive. You can leave them outside in summer, as long as there is adequate protection and shelter from rain. Bring inside during winter and place on a sunny windowsill in a warm room.

WATERING AND FEEDING

The easiest way to water these is to place the tins in a shallow container of water, leave until the surface of the compost is moist, then lift out and leave to drain. Water regularly in the growing season – every 10 days or so – and add a diluted liquid feed to the water during spring and summer. Do not feed or water in autumn and winter.